

Health and safety

Ensure that your workplace meets the legal safety requirements set by your government and local authorities.

US

Workplace health and safety
www.dol.gov/general/topic/safety-health

Canada

Canadian Centre for Occupational Health and Safety
www.ccohs.ca/oshanswers/legisl/intro.html

Retail law

Retail laws vary widely by state and local municipality, and the best resource for following laws to sell retail is a local lawyer who specializes in small retail businesses.

Consumer protection/rights

Understand how local consumer law affects your business.

US

The Bureau of Consumer Protection prevents fraudulent business practices and educates businesses about their rights and responsibilities.
www.ftc.gov/about-ftc/bureaus-offices/bureau-consumer-protection

Canada

Consumer protection legislation in Canada
www.ic.gc.ca/eic/site/Oca-bc.nsf/eng/ca02965.html

Data protection

There is no one law protecting data and businesses, but there are many industry- and state-specific protection laws.

US

The Federal Trade Commission oversees compliance with privacy and data protection laws and regulations.
www.ftc.gov

Canada

Privacy laws for businesses
www.priv.gc.ca/en/for-businesses

Cybersecurity

If your business handles personal data, you have a legal responsibility to protect that data from cyber attacks.

US

Stay safe from cybersecurity threats
www.sba.gov/business-guide/manage-your-business/stay-safe-cybersecurity-threats

Canada

Cybersecurity for small business
cyber.gc.ca/en/guidance/cyber-security-small-business

Environmental law

You must follow local environmental standards and laws.

US

US Environmental Protection Agency
www.epa.gov/laws-regulations

Canada

Acts and Regulations: Environment and Climate Change Canada
www.canada.ca/en/environment-climate-change/corporate/transparency/acts-regulations.html

Getting green accreditation

Look into the requirements for your region and industry-specific accreditation.

US

Green America
www.greenamerica.org/green-america-green-business-certification

Canada

There is no central Canadian accreditation agency for general business but there are many industry-specific ones.

International

Green Seal—global but headquartered in US
www.greenseal.org